

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	Medium

Question
In the xy -plane, the graph of the linear function f contains the points $(0, 2)$ and $(8, 34)$. Which equation defines f , where $y = f(x)$?

- Answer**
- A. $f(x) = 2x + 42$
- B. $f(x) = 32x + 36$
- C. $f(x) = 4x + 2$
- D. $f(x) = 8x + 2$

Correct Answer: C

Rationale
Choice C is correct. In the xy -plane, the graph of a linear function can be written in the form $f(x) = mx + b$, where m represents the slope and $(0, b)$ represents the y -intercept of the graph of $y = f(x)$. It's given that the graph of the linear function f , where $y = f(x)$, in the xy -plane contains the point $(0, 2)$. Thus, $b = 2$. The slope of the graph of a line containing any two points (x_1, y_1) and (x_2, y_2) can be found using the slope formula, $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$. Since it's given that the graph of the linear function f contains the points $(0, 2)$ and $(8, 34)$, it follows that the slope of the graph of the line containing these points is $m = \frac{34 - 2}{8 - 0}$, or $m = 4$. Substituting 4 for m and 2 for b in $f(x) = mx + b$ yields $f(x) = 4x + 2$.

Choice A is incorrect. This function represents a graph with a slope of 2 and a y -intercept of $(0, 42)$.

Choice B is incorrect. This function represents a graph with a slope of 32 and a y -intercept of $(0, 36)$.

Choice D is incorrect. This function represents a graph with a slope of 8 and a y -intercept of $(0, 2)$.